

Indirect objects

CHAPITRE 2

In English An **indirect object** is the person *to whom* or *for whom* something is done. The indirect object noun can either go before or after the direct object. However, when it follows the direct object, the preposition **to** must be used.

My parents gave **my cousin** a gift.

My parents gave a gift **to my cousin**.

You can ask yourself *to whom* or *for whom* the action occurs in order to determine what the indirect object is. Verbs such as **to send**, **to show**, and **to give** often have indirect objects.

I sent **my uncle** a thank you note.

(*To whom* did I send a thank you note? *To my uncle*.)

A Circle the indirect objects in the following sentences.

1. I wrote my best friend many e-mails while I was away.
2. Who sent that package to you?
3. I brought my grandmother a bouquet of daisies.
4. My parents bought my brother and me a new computer!
5. Let's write our congresswoman a letter.
6. We gave the dog a big, juicy bone.

In French An **indirect object** is also the person who benefits from the action of the verb. It is almost always preceded by the preposition **à**. Indirect objects are often used with verbs of giving and receiving (**donner**, **offrir**, **envoyer**) and of communicating (**parler**, **téléphoner**, **dire**).

Je vais envoyer une invitation **à ton cousin**.

J'écris **à Agnès**.

Les élèves parlent **au professeur**.

B Circle the indirect objects in the following sentences.

1. Tu peux offrir un CD à Sophie.
2. Je dois téléphoner à mes parents.
3. Est-ce que vous pouvez donner ce livre à Jean-Luc?
4. Le prof d'histoire va rendre les devoirs aux élèves.
5. Nous pouvons parler à Mylène et à François à la fête.
6. Ma tante offre toujours des chocolats aux enfants.

INDIRECT OBJECTS

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C Rewrite the following scrambled sentences so the words are in the correct order. Then circle the indirect object in each sentence.

1. Nous / des cadeaux / à / donnons / nos amis

Nous donnons des cadeaux à nos amis. _____

2. J' / une carte de vœux / écris / à / mes grands-parents

3. Les Hébert / aux / leur maison / parents de Martin / vendent

4. Notre chien / le journal / apporte / aux filles

5. Je / mon père / vais / de l'argent / à / demander

6. J'offre / à / mon / un ballon / petit ami

7. Tu / une invitation / sœurs d'Alice / n'envoies / pas / aux

D Compare the following sentences. What can you conclude about English and French verbs that take direct and indirect objects?

Il **répond** à la lettre.

He *answers* the letter.

Il **téléphone** à Alice.

He *phones* Alice.

Elle **demande** toujours à Marc.

She always *asks* Marc.

Indirect object pronouns

CHAPITRE 2

In English An indirect object noun can be replaced by an **indirect object pronoun**. In English, these are **me, you, him, her, us, you (plural), and them**.

My grandmother told **me** that story years ago.

I gave your books to **them**.

When both direct and indirect objects are expressed as pronouns in the same sentence, the indirect object pronoun goes after **to** or **for**.

Rachel sent **it** to **her**.

He's preparing **it** for **you**.

A Underline the indirect object pronoun in each sentence.

1. Who gave me this present?
2. He did not know her, but offered it to her anyway.
3. Why did you give him a small tip?
4. Who writes you so many letters?
5. Frank gave it to us last week.
6. She explained everything to me.
7. Could you leave the lights on for them?

In French **Indirect object pronouns** are also used to avoid repeating the noun. They are placed before the conjugated verb or before an infinitive.

me (m') (to/for me)

nous (to/for us)

te (t') (to/for you)

vous (to/for you, formal, plural)

lui (to/for him/her)

leur (to/for them)

Alors, je **vous** envoie une invitation à ma fête.

Il va **lui** offrir des fleurs.

If you have a sentence with both direct and indirect object pronouns, place the pronouns in the following order.

me	} before	le	} before	lui
te		la		
nous		l'		
vous		les		
				leur

J'envoie **cette carte à mon ami**. → Je **la lui** envoie.

Je **te** donne **son numéro de téléphone**. → Je **te le** donne.

INDIRECT OBJECT PRONOUNS

CHAPITRE 2

B Underline the indirect object pronoun in each sentence.

1. Nous allons te l'acheter.
2. Je ne lui prête pas mes choses.
3. Il vous a dit tout, n'est-ce pas?
4. Son père va la lui prêter.
5. Est-ce que vous allez nous le vendre?
6. Gilles ne veut pas me le montrer.
7. Tu vas la leur envoyer?

C Complete the following sentences with the correct indirect object pronouns.

1. —Qu'est-ce que je dois faire pour M. Pelletier?
—Tu dois _____ **lui** _____ écrire une lettre.
2. —Tu poses souvent des questions aux professeurs?
—Non, je _____ pose rarement des questions.
3. —Quand est-ce que tu vas nous montrer les photos?
—Je vais _____ les montrer demain.
4. —Vas-tu acheter un CD à Simone?
—Oui, je vais _____ acheter celui-ci.

D Write the answer to each question using a direct and an indirect object pronoun.

1. Qui nous envoie cette lettre? (Grégoire)
Grégoire nous l'envoie. _____
2. Qui m'écrit les e-mails? (Lorraine)

3. Qui nous rend les livres? (Sylvie et Maude)

4. Qui va t'acheter la voiture? (mon grand-père)

5. Qui donne ce cadeau à Bruno? (sa tante)

6. Qui va prêter les bicyclettes aux garçons? (M. Dupuy)
